

Will Certifications Related to FOSS Help You Get a Job?

OSFY reached out to its Facebook community, Linux User Groups and hiring managers for answers to the above question....



First, a candid admission: a story on FOSS certification wasn't really on the cards for this issue. So, why did we, at OSFY, contemplate assigning space to a topic that did not seem to be particularly 'hot' in the open source circuits? Well, if a topic is measured by its newsworthiness, this one sure generated a buzz on our Facebook page. In response to a question we posted, "How important are certifications related to FOSS when it comes to the job market?" we were bombarded with a flurry of diverse opinions.

While we stayed glued to the engaging conversations and the live debate happening on our wall, we decided to encapsulate the essence of the discussion into an article, to be shared with OSFY readers. When we subsequently posed the same question to members of the various Linux User Groups (LUG) and to some industry leaders to gauge their reactions, the debate got livelier.

So, do certifications help?

With the increasing adoption of open source on a global scale, the significance of certifications related to FOSS is also growing. Alok Srivastava, CEO, Network Nuts, who is also an RHCE, believes that FOSS certifications do augment one's career prospects, as they did for him. "Certifications are objective assessments of your skills and help the hiring managers select candidates with potential from the vast talent pool. Compared to my peers, I was quick to get an interview call from a noted IT company. That's the major advantage of possessing a certification. Being certified also boosts your self-esteem," says Srivastava.

While Srivastava feels FOSS related certifications are valued in today's IT scenario, Puneet Chhabra, an active member of our Facebook community, doesn't think so. In response to our question, he wrote, "Certifications are